SYNTHETIC DEMO SOLICITATION — NOT AN ACTUAL GOVERNMENT REQUIREMENT

PART IV — REPRESENTATIONS AND INSTRUCTIONS

SECTION M — EVALUATION FACTORS FOR AWARD

Solicitation No. 36C10B-27-R-0059 · Veterans Claims Intake Modernization · Department of Veterans Affairs

M.1 BASIS FOR AWARD

The Government intends to award a single contract resulting from this solicitation to the responsible offeror whose proposal, conforming to the solicitation, represents the best value to the Government using a tradeoff process in accordance with FAR 15.101-1. The Government may award to other than the lowest priced offeror or other than the highest technically rated offeror. The Government intends to award without discussions but reserves the right to conduct discussions if determined necessary by the Contracting Officer.

M.2 EVALUATION FACTORS AND RELATIVE IMPORTANCE

Proposals will be evaluated on the following factors:

Factor	Title	Evaluated from	Rating method
1	Technical Approach	Volume I — Technical	Combined technical/risk rating
2	Management Approach	Volume II — Management	Combined technical/risk rating
3	Past Performance	Volume III — Past Performance	Performance confidence assessment
4	Price	Volume IV — Price	Evaluated, not rated

Technical Approach is more important than Management Approach, which is more important than Past Performance. All non-price factors, when combined, are significantly more important than Price.

M.3 FACTOR 1 — TECHNICAL APPROACH

The Government will evaluate the offeror's approach to classifying and extracting data from incoming claim evidence, routing established claims to the right work queue, and delivering a Section 508 conformant experience for Veterans and VA staff.

The Technical Approach factor consists of the following subfactors, which are of equal importance:

(a) Intelligent document intake and classification

(b) Claims routing and workload management

(c) Accessibility and Section 508 conformance

This factor will be evaluated from Volume I — Technical. The Government will assign a combined technical/risk rating.

M.4 FACTOR 2 — MANAGEMENT APPROACH

The Government will evaluate the qualifications and committed availability of the Program Manager and Solution Architect, the offeror's plan to assume full responsibility within 60 days of award, and its approach to staffing and retention.

The Management Approach factor consists of the following subfactors, which are of equal importance:

(a) Key personnel

(b) Transition-in plan

(c) Staffing and retention

This factor will be evaluated from Volume II — Management. The Government will assign a combined technical/risk rating.

M.5 FACTOR 3 — PAST PERFORMANCE

The Government will assess confidence based on recent and relevant performance on benefits claims intake, document processing or case management efforts.

The Past Performance factor consists of the following elements:

(a) Recency

(b) Relevancy

(c) Quality

This factor will be evaluated from Volume III — Past Performance. The Government will assign a performance confidence assessment rating.

M.6 FACTOR 4 — PRICE

Price will be evaluated for reasonableness. Total evaluated price is the sum of all fixed-price CLINs for the base and option periods. Price will not be rated. The Government will evaluate price for reasonableness in accordance with FAR 15.404-1 and may evaluate for balance. Unbalanced pricing may be grounds for rejection of the proposal.

M.7 RATING DEFINITIONS

Table M-1. Combined technical/risk ratings

Rating	Description
Outstanding	Proposal indicates an exceptional approach and understanding of the requirements and contains multiple strengths, and risk of unsuccessful performance is low.
Good	Proposal indicates a thorough approach and understanding of the requirements and contains at least one strength, and risk of unsuccessful performance is low to moderate.
Acceptable	Proposal indicates an adequate approach and understanding of the requirements, and risk of unsuccessful performance is no worse than moderate.
Marginal	Proposal has not demonstrated an adequate approach and understanding of the requirements, and/or risk of unsuccessful performance is high.
Unacceptable	Proposal does not meet requirements of the solicitation and, thus, contains one or more deficiencies, and/or risk of unsuccessful performance is unacceptable. Proposal is unawardable.

Table M-2. Past performance confidence assessment ratings

Rating	Description
Substantial Confidence	Based on the offeror's recent/relevant performance record, the Government has a high expectation that the offeror will successfully perform the required effort.
Satisfactory Confidence	Based on the offeror's recent/relevant performance record, the Government has a reasonable expectation that the offeror will successfully perform the required effort.
Neutral Confidence	No recent/relevant performance record is available or the record is so sparse that no meaningful confidence assessment rating can be reasonably assigned. The offeror may not be evaluated favorably or unfavorably on the factor of past performance.

Rating	Description
Limited Confidence	Based on the offeror's recent/relevant performance record, the Government has a low expectation that the offeror will successfully perform the required effort.
No Confidence	Based on the offeror's recent/relevant performance record, the Government has no expectation that the offeror will be able to successfully perform the required effort.

SECTION L — EXCERPT

L.4 PROPOSAL VOLUMES AND PAGE LIMITATIONS

Offerors shall submit the following volumes. Pages in excess of the stated limits will not be evaluated.

Volume	Page limitation
Volume I — Technical	Not to exceed 25 pages
Volume II — Management	Not to exceed 15 pages
Volume III — Past Performance	Not to exceed 10 pages
Volume IV — Price	No page limit